



Unit-5

Etiquettes



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Topics to discuss:

- ▶ Telephonic etiquettes
- ▶ Time Management
- ▶ Etiquettes for foreign business trips
- ▶ Visit to foreign Counterparts
- ▶ Etiquettes for small talks
- ▶ Respecting privacy
- ▶ Learning to say NO

Telephonic Etiquettes



Telephonic Etiquettes:

- ▶ In the contemporary world, most of our conversations, and discussions with others take place over the phone. Telephone or cell phone is, in fact, the most commonly used tool of communication, among professions staying in different parts of the world.
- ▶ Whether one works in a large or a small organization, professionals need to interact mostly through telephones.

Telephonic Etiquettes:

1. Identify yourself and thank them for contacting you

2. Try to remain positive

3. Consider the tone and speed of your voice

4. Listen carefully

5. Respond

6. Remain composed

7. End well

8. Time your call

9. Be precise and clear

Tips for an Effective Telephonic Conversation:

- ▶ Spoken courtesy on a telephone can reap rewards we may not expect.
- ▶ Never raise your voice on the phone.
- ▶ Try to speak clearly with the receiver a couple inches away from the mouth- not too far, not too close or on the lips.
- ▶ Take notes during the call, and record the date and time. Keep all your notes in one place.
- ▶ When you call back and get an answering machine, do not hang up. Leave a complete message with your name and telephone number.
- ▶ Receive a little formal training in telephonic communication.

Time Management

Chronemics:

- ▶ The study of how human beings communicate through their use of time is known as **Chronemics**.
- ▶ Types:
 1. Mono Chronic
 - To do one thing at a time. For example: watching T.V.
 2. Poly Chronic
 - To do several things at a time. For example: watching T.V. while eating food.
- ▶ Importance of Time Management.

Etiquettes for foreign business trips



General Tips:

- ▶ Don't criticize or deride your organization under any circumstance, and especially in mixed company.
- ▶ Make only those commitment that are within your level of authority.
- ▶ You are also representing your country – India. In your awe of seeing American can expressways, do not bad mouth Indian roads and traffic to your American counterparts.
- ▶ Do not hesitate to keep your religious and personal identity.
- ▶ If you food habits that require social needs (e.g. vegetarianism), make sure you use the internet and other resources to find out appropriate places nearby.



Before the Trip:

► Know Your Objectives:

- ➔ It can be a technical mission,
- ➔ A knowledge transfer by which you are going to get trained by your foreign counterparts,
- ➔ A rapport building,
- ➔ Building network or
- ➔ The final step in winning an off-shoring deal.

► Prepare Well:

- ➔ Make sure you have assembled and organized all data required for your trip both in the hard copy and in the soft copy, as necessary.
- ➔ Build redundancy and save your important material in two or three places. Make contingency plans for such possibilities as lost luggage and have someone in your home base who can feed you computer files, data and other things in a pinch.

- ➔ Make sure you have written down the contact numbers of essential people and places in your cell phone as well as in your old-fashioned diary.
- ➔ Make sure you have all travel documents in order.
- ➔ Make sure you carry power adapters for the several different power outlets of the parts of the world you visiting. It is good idea to have universal adapter.
- ➔ Finally, make sure you bring with you plenty of your latest business cards and a diary or journal with a couple of good pens.

During the Trip:

- ▶ Be aware of the local laws and practices.
- ▶ Respect Privacy.
- ▶ Interface with your foreign team.
- ▶ Pay attention to networking.
- ▶ Help conduct perfect presentations and meetings.
- ▶ Be in constant touch with your home base and your boss in India.
- ▶ A business trip is not a junket.

After the Trip:

- ▶ First, send a courteous 'Thank You' mail to your counter parts, thanking them for their hospitality and for the productive time you had.
- ▶ Then, sit down with your boss and brief him on the trip.
- ▶ Then, write an appropriate trip report and circulate it among the relevant people.
- ▶ Next, follow through on the action items you promised and take them to completion.
- ▶ At last, don't forget to file that expense report promptly with all your receipts, before you start your next trip on your glob trotting.



Visits of Foreign Counterparts

Business manners in different countries:

► Americans:

- ➔ Shaking hands during introductions is common.
- ➔ Punctuality is an important form of courtesy.
- ➔ Americans prefer breakfast meeting to develop close business relations. They also have meetings over lunch.
- ➔ Americans prefer to refer to people by their first names.

► Europeans:

1. British:

British businessmen share most of their culture and business matters with other Europeans. They are formal in meetings and personal style.

2. French:

French businessmen usually choose to speak in French with businessmen from other countries. They are very cordial and greet each other by shaking hands.

3. Germans:

German business meetings are highly formal and scheduled much in advance. Germans can explain themselves in English if required. People are addressed by their surnames. Senior businessmen are shown respect by sometimes being referred to as “Herr” (Mr.). Similarly business women are always addressed as “Frau” (Mrs.).

4. Italian and Spanish:

Both Italians and Spanish like business occasions as part of social life and may be less formal than other Europeans.

5. Dutch:

Dutch businessmen speak English fluently. Most of them are polyglots (speaking or writing several languages). They are relaxed in their business approach.

► The Japanese:

- ➔ The Japanese always like to maintain personal space, so physical contact is not desirable.
- ➔ It is polite to offer and accept of business cards with both hands.
- ➔ Japanese business people should be addressed by using Mr am Ms, never by the first name.
- ➔ In Japan saying “no” is considered impolite.
- ➔ They consider giving gifts to be an important part of business.
- ➔ Red cards in Japan are funeral notices, so red greeting cards are not used for business.

► Arabs:

- ➔ Arabs businessmen are known for their warm hearted greetings. They stick to their traditional way of greeting, both as hosts and visitors, by saying “Salaam Alaikum” (peace be upon you).
- ➔ Discussions on religious and political matters are strictly avoided.
- ➔ Business meeting are conducted in a leisurely style.
- ➔ To an Arab business person, giving gifts is a part of hospitality.
- ➔ Never give handkerchief as gifts to an Arab, as they symbolize tears and parting.

► Indians:

- ➔ Indians have been known for their hospitality.
- ➔ In India, visitors are always treated utmost attention and respect.
- ➔ Business meetings are punctual, well planned and formally conducted and protocol of seniority is observed.
- ➔ In matters of business discussion, juniors always give precedence to their seniors.
- ➔ Business cards are exchanged while parting.
- ➔ Presentation of small gifts at the end of the meeting is considered to be gesture of goodwill.



Etiquettes For Small Talks

Etiquettes For Small Talks:

- ▶ Small talk is usually a prelude to a more serious business conversation.
- ▶ It is shallow, informal and somewhat impersonal conversation.
- ▶ It can last anywhere from a few minutes to a very long time.
- ▶ It is a part of the ice-breaking process
- ▶ There is nothing small about small talk.
- ▶ Small talk is an important people skill.

- ▶ Establishing connection
- ▶ Helps in forging a meaningful and lasting relationships with your business associate, a potential client and an existing client.
- ▶ An easy way to gain confidence in dealing with different people.
- ▶ Organizations look for people with such skills.

Tips for small talks:

- ▶ Have a positive body language with smile and demonstrate your interest and desire to communicate.
- ▶ Say a hello first, introduce yourself and ask open ended questions
- ▶ The best topic to start with is always about the weather and other general topics.
- ▶ Be more interested in the other person rather than continuously talking about yourself.
- ▶ It is advisable to think before you speak.
- ▶ Discuss general things like movies, sports, books, hobbies etc.

- ▶ Avoid topics like your health issues, your own personal problems, and the cost of things, gossips and controversial issues like politics or religion.
- ▶ Do not walk away abruptly, close the conversation with a graceful line “it’s been nice talking to you.”

Respecting Privacy

Respecting Privacy:

- ▶ An employer's need for information should be balanced with an employee's right to privacy.

- ▶ The following basic rules help to establish and maintain that balance:
 - To respect privacy is the fundamental concept of many societies.
 - People wish to have privacy not only at their homes, but also at the workplace.
 - As for the employer, it is important to monitor employee activity through CCTV camera and track the internet, email, social media and telephone use.
 - The monitoring of employees may be necessary but every human being has a right to privacy as far as their personal information is concerned.
 - An employer must take consent from the employee before sharing any of their personal information like contact numbers.
 - As an employee, you must also respect privacy of your other colleagues.
 - While indulging in informal talks during a lunch or tea break, do not ask personal questions by which others get intimidated.

Learning To Say NO

Learning to Say NO:

- ▶ When we do activities which are other people's priorities, we end up accomplishing nothing at the end of the day.
- ▶ People usually are not able to say no, even if they want to, let's see why people are not able to say no:
 - ➔ Generally, we have a need of acceptance, of importance and of sense of belonging, we don't say no.
 - ➔ We have strong ego sense, where we consider ourselves to be always helpful to others, at that time, we don't say no.
 - ➔ When we don't have our own plans, we are vulnerable to fit into plans of others. We think that because we don't have anything to do now, so we can easily accommodate for other people's priorities.
 - ➔ We are not aware of our own priorities because we never visualized our goals or planned for it.
 - ➔ We are guided by our impulse or desire rather than our set principles. This happens because we have actually not set our principles.
 - ➔ Lack of power of taking decisions.

What happens when we are not able to say a no?

1. We end up wasting time which we may have utilized in doing activities of our own priorities.
2. We are not able to meet our deadlines and are always in a crisis.
3. Even though we may have helped other people but it does not necessarily mean that we will be in good books of others.
4. Because of our habit of giving priority to other people's priorities, we end up missing our deadlines and it creates a bad impression.
5. As we start seeing that our own work remains unfinished, we go into resentment and it becomes a vicious cycle.